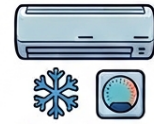


ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

HVAC & Refrigeration English



Vocabulary & phrasebook

Keep precise meanings and useful expressions close. Retrieve the words, then use them in a complete message.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, and refrigeration technicians, supervised apprentices, service coordinators, and mechanical crew leads.

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All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Make vocabulary usable

Knowing a definition is a start. To use a term well, explain it in plain English, connect it to a case, and choose a natural sentence around it.

- Read five terms, cover their definitions, and recall the meanings.
- Sort a pair you might confuse and explain the difference.
- Use one term in a sentence about a fictional case.
- Ask a partner to explain the sentence without repeating the specialist word.
- Return to the same terms on another day and test recall again.

Abbreviations need context

Expand an abbreviation on first use when the listener needs it. Some abbreviations have different meanings across professions: API can refer to an application programming interface or an active pharmaceutical ingredient. The course context determines the meaning.

Definitions have limits

These are concise language-learning explanations, not complete legal, clinical, or technical specifications. Use the applicable authoritative definition for regulated or operational decisions.

Field vocabulary A-Z

air handler

Equipment that conditions or circulates air through a building system using components such as fans and coils.

airflow

The quantity of air moving through a point or system over time, stated with its measurement basis.

alarm history

A record of equipment alarm events, including their identifiers, times, and available status information.

ambient temperature

The temperature of the surrounding air at an identified place and time.

asset tag

A site-assigned identifier linking a particular equipment item to its location and records.

cabinet temperature

A temperature associated with air or a sensor location in a refrigerated cabinet, distinct from the temperature of stored products.

change proposal

A defined suggested alteration to agreed work, with its cost, timing, and approval status stated for review.

commissioning report

A record of specified verification activities, results, and limitations associated with confirming intended system performance.

condensate

Liquid water formed when moisture in air condenses, commonly associated with cooling equipment.

condensing unit

An assembly containing components that reject heat as refrigerant condenses, commonly located separately from the indoor equipment.

cooling capacity

The rate at which equipment is rated to remove heat under stated conditions.

defrost cycle

A specified operating phase intended to remove accumulated frost from relevant refrigeration surfaces.

drain pan

A component intended to collect condensate or other specified drainage beneath equipment.

ductwork

The network of passages carrying air between equipment and served locations.

evaporator

A component where refrigerant absorbs heat as it evaporates.

grille

A covering with openings through which air passes, typically at a room or duct opening.

maintenance interval

The stated period or condition between maintenance activities for particular equipment or tasks.

matched system

A combination of equipment components identified as compatible for the specified application and rating basis.

nameplate

The manufacturer's equipment label showing identification and specified ratings or other product information.

outstanding item

A specific unresolved work, record, or review requirement retained for follow-up.

product temperature

The temperature of a stored item, measured and interpreted under the relevant product-specific procedures.

provisional diagnosis

A tentative explanation of a heating, cooling, or refrigeration issue that remains subject to confirmation.

refrigerant designation

The standardized identifier for the working fluid specified for a refrigeration system or component.

return air

Air drawn from a served space back toward the system for recirculation or treatment.

service clearance

Space specified for access to equipment during inspection, maintenance, or other service activity.

service log

A dated record of equipment visits, reported symptoms, observations, and work performed.

setpoint

The target value requested by a control, distinct from a measured condition.

static pressure

Pressure exerted by air in a duct apart from its velocity pressure, stated relative to a reference and interpreted with the measurement location and conditions.

supply air

Air delivered by a system into the space it serves.

thermal zone

An area treated as a unit for heating or cooling control or assessment.

thermostat

A device that senses temperature and requests heating or cooling according to its configured controls.

warranty exclusion

A condition or circumstance expressly outside the coverage described in a warranty document.

Expressions for this course

Complete the frames with the facts of your case. A frame helps organize meaning; it should not replace an actual explanation.

Ask which number is being reported

Does that display show ___ or ___?

The complaint concerns ___ after ___ .

The target is ___; the measured condition remains ___.

A thermostat display may show different values. Ask what the existing label says rather than directing control changes. Comfort descriptions are useful information, but they do not by themselves identify a system fault.

Word combinations in this lesson

identify the occupied zone: name the area where people report discomfort

distinguish target from reading: separate a requested value from a measured one

record the complaint pattern: note when and where the concern occurs

clarify the display label: establish what a displayed number represents

Verify the asset rather than trusting a similar label

The request says ___; the register identifies ___ .

Is that an asset tag or a ___?

The component relationship remains ___.

Site asset tags, manufacturer model numbers, and serial numbers identify different things. Similar suffixes do not prove components are paired. Work from supplied records; do not ask learners to access plant, roofs, or enclosed machinery.

Word combinations in this lesson

read back the asset tag: repeat the site's equipment identifier

match the indoor and outdoor records: verify the documented component relationship

distinguish model from serial number: separate a product type from an individual unit identifier

locate the service history: find records for the identified equipment

Use direction and measurement context

___ delivers air; ___ draws air back.

The report gives ___, not ___.

A valid comparison needs the same ___.

Supply and return describe direction and function. Airflow and static pressure are different quantities requiring stated measurement context. Do not teach damper adjustment, testing steps, or conclusions from invented limits.

Word combinations in this lesson

distinguish supply from return: identify air delivered to and drawn from a space

compare reported readings: use matching units, locations, and conditions

describe uneven distribution: state where the comfort difference is reported

request the balancing report: obtain the record of specified air-distribution assessment

Compare like quantities and complete combinations

Both numbers use ___, but one describes ___.

The rating applies under ___.

Compatibility of the proposed combination remains ___.

Capacity and electrical input can use the same unit while describing different quantities. A refrigerant designation is an identifier, not a handling instruction or proof of interchangeability. Use complete product information for specialist review.

Word combinations in this lesson

check the complete rating: include the stated conditions and units

verify the equipment pairing: confirm the specified indoor and outdoor combination

compare capacity on the same basis: avoid unlike rating conditions

confirm the refrigerant reference: identify the documented fluid designation without handling it

Use the service log without assuming recurrence

The earlier entry records ___, while today's note says ___ .

That may be relevant, but it doesn't establish ___ .

The diagnosis remains provisional because ___.

A previous drain-pan concern does not prove a new wet-floor report shares its cause. Condensate is a type of moisture, not a diagnosis of every puddle. Discuss supplied observations without teaching investigation or repair.

Word combinations in this lesson

describe the observed moisture: state its location and time without naming a source

preserve the visit limits: retain what the technician did and did not establish

link the service entry: connect a report to the correct equipment and date

qualify the suspected cause: label a possible explanation as unconfirmed

Separate equipment evidence from product decisions

This value comes from ___, not ___ .

The entries coincide, but ___ remains unconfirmed.

The equipment enquiry is ___; the product decision belongs with ___.

An air or sensor reading is not automatically a product-temperature result. A defrost entry does not make an alarm harmless by definition. Preserve records and refer stock decisions promptly to the responsible site specialist; do not supply temperature thresholds or operating changes.

Word combinations in this lesson

identify the sensor location: establish what the recorded value represents

align the timestamps: compare records using a consistent time basis

preserve the alarm history: retain events rather than erase inconvenient entries

refer stock decisions: direct product-safety or disposition questions to the responsible person

Discuss the visible request and its wider scope

The visible request is ____; the wider review includes ____.

We can retain ____ or assess ____.

Please distinguish ____ from ____ in the proposal.

A small visible change can affect concealed work and another trade's finishes. Name those possible dependencies without inventing their extent. Service clearance is project- and equipment-specific; do not offer universal dimensions.

Word combinations in this lesson

coordinate the ceiling layout: reconcile equipment, air openings, and other ceiling elements

preserve the stated service clearance: account for the manufacturer's or design review's access requirement

define the relocation scope: specify which items a proposed move includes

compare restoration responsibilities: identify who repairs finishes affected by a change

Explain the remaining obligations precisely

The report is received, but ____ is deferred.

The maintenance information applies to ____, not ____.

____ owns ____; the separate visit remains ____.

A report may contain completed activities and explicit limitations. Match maintenance information to the actual equipment and its stated source. Do not invent intervals, interpret warranty rights, or turn a status call into a service booking.

Word combinations in this lesson

match the manual to the equipment: verify the document reference against the supplied unit

separate completed from deferred: identify work done and work still outstanding

confirm the maintenance basis: identify the source of the stated interval

transfer the follow-up: agree who owns the unresolved item and next update

Model responses in context

Read the situation first. Cover the model, say your own response, and compare the two for meaning and tone.

01 | Clarifying comfort complaints and thermostat readings

An office manager says the meeting room is 22 degrees Celsius. The number is the thermostat setpoint, not a confirmed ambient-temperature reading. Staff report feeling warm there after 14:00. No cause or equipment fault has been established.

Is 22 degrees the target shown on the thermostat, or a measured room-temperature reading? I will record it as the setpoint if that is the display label. The staff's report concerns feeling warm in the meeting-room zone after 14:00. We still need to distinguish that comfort report from measured conditions and any technical finding.

Try it again: The manager asks whether lowering the setting will solve the complaint. Keep the exchange to information gathering, not operating advice.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

02 | Identifying equipment and linked components

A school request names AC-4, but the roof plan labels outdoor unit CU-4 and the indoor equipment register labels air handler AH-4. Their relationship is not confirmed. The facilities manager has the equipment register; learners must not access a roof or inspect equipment to obtain information.

Could you confirm which asset AC-4 refers to in the request? The records list outdoor unit CU-4 and air handler AH-4, but their matching numbers do not establish that they serve the same system. Please provide the relevant equipment-register entries so we can verify the relationship before attaching the service history.

Try it again: The manager says a photograph of a different site's unit looks identical. Explain why appearance is not an asset reference.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

03 | Explaining airflow and distribution reports

A client calls both ceiling openings air-conditioning outlets. The current drawing identifies S3 as supply air and R2 as return air. The client reports discomfort below S3 but provides no airflow measurements. The technician must explain the labels without diagnosing poor performance or prescribing adjustments.

On this drawing, S3 delivers supply air into the room, while R2 draws return air back toward the system. They are not interchangeable outlet labels. Your discomfort below S3 is useful location information, but it does not by itself establish an airflow value or a cause. We can refer the report with those references clearly identified.

Try it again: The client wants a control adjustment immediately. Keep the response to the documented labels and the need for assessment.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

04 | Checking equipment ratings and refrigerant references

Two fictional proposals both say 5 kilowatts, but proposal A labels that cooling capacity and proposal B labels it electrical input. The client calls them equal-size systems. Full data sheets and equipment pairings are not supplied. No selection is approved.

The two 5-kilowatt figures describe different quantities. Proposal A states cooling capacity, while proposal B states electrical input. We cannot treat them as equal-capacity systems from those numbers. Please obtain the full data sheets, rating conditions, and proposed component pairings so the reviewer can compare like for like before we discuss a selection.

Try it again: The seller says the refrigerant designation matches. Explain why that alone does not establish a matched system.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

05 | Reporting moisture, symptoms, and service findings

A client reports water near air handler AH-6 at 15:00 yesterday. Today's supplied visit note says the nearby floor is dry and the source was not identified. An earlier log mentions a drain-pan concern but does not establish a link. No learner is asked to inspect equipment.

The supplied visit note records a dry floor today, not a confirmed resolution of yesterday's report. The earlier drain-pan entry may be relevant history, but it does not establish the current source. I will link the dated reports to AH-6 and keep any explanation provisional until the technical reviewer confirms what the evidence supports.

Try it again: The client suggests replacing the unit immediately. Explain the difference between a concern requiring assessment and an established replacement need.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

06 | Discussing refrigeration alarms and temperature records

A fictional cafe cabinet display recorded 8 degrees Celsius at 06:10. Product temperatures were not supplied. An alarm-history entry has the same time as a scheduled defrost entry, but the cause and duration are unconfirmed. The cafe manager asks whether the food is safe. The responsible food-safety lead must decide under the site's procedures.

The 8-degree value is a cabinet reading at 06:10, not a supplied product-temperature result. The alarm and scheduled defrost entries share a timestamp, but that does not establish the cause or duration. I cannot decide food safety from this record. Please involve your food-safety lead while we clarify the equipment history.

Try it again: The manager asks for a guarantee that the stock can be sold. Decline that judgment and identify the food-safety lead while preserving the equipment enquiry.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

07 | Coordinating ductwork, access, and changes

An office client wants a supply grille moved because it conflicts visually with a pendant light. The proposal has not assessed ductwork, ceiling restoration, service access, price, or timing. The client can retain the current reviewed layout or request a coordinated change proposal.

We can retain the current reviewed layout or request a coordinated proposal for the grille relocation. The visible grille is only part of the change; ductwork, ceiling restoration, access, cost, and timing may also need review. Could you provide the revised lighting position so both layouts can be assessed together before any change is agreed?

Try it again: The decorator quotes ceiling restoration separately. Explain the combined comparison without assuming the original mechanical price includes it.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

08 | Handing over commissioning and maintenance information

A fictional office system's commissioning report is received but lists a deferred seasonal check. The maintenance sheet names the wrong model. Coordinator Nia accepts document correction and will update the client Friday. The seasonal-check date is not booked, and responsibility for scheduling it has not yet been confirmed. Who will arrange the check remains an open question. No overall performance or warranty conclusion is supplied.

Nia has accepted follow-up on the maintenance sheet, which names the wrong model, and will update you Friday. We haven't confirmed who will book the seasonal check; that question remains open. Could we confirm who will take responsibility for booking it? The commissioning report is received, but the check remains deferred and no date is booked.

Try it again: The supplier sends a generic family manual. Keep applicability pending verification rather than closing the correction merely because a file arrived.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

Use the language responsibly

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Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Heating, Air Conditioning, and Refrigeration Mechanics and Installers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/installation-maintenance-and-repair/heating-air-conditioning-and-refrigeration-mechanics-and-installers.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Heating, Air Conditioning, and Refrigeration Mechanics and Installers (49-9021.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/49-9021.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Build vocabulary and collocations

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: HVAC & Refrigeration English

Professional audience: Heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, and refrigeration technicians, supervised apprentices, service coordinators, and mechanical crew leads

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Lesson 01: Clarifying comfort complaints and thermostat readings

Original fictional case: An office manager says the meeting room is 22 degrees Celsius. The number is the thermostat setpoint, not a confirmed ambient-temperature reading. Staff report feeling warm there after 14:00. No cause or equipment fault has been established.

Language workshop: Ask which number is being reported

Communication goal: Separate a control target, a temperature observation, and a comfort complaint.

Language guidance: A thermostat display may show different values. Ask what the existing label says rather than directing control changes. Comfort descriptions are useful information, but they do not by themselves identify a system fault.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Does that display show ___ or ___? / The complaint concerns ___ after ___. / The target is ___; the measured condition remains ___.

Vocabulary: thermostat: A device that senses temperature and requests heating or cooling according to its configured controls. / setpoint: The target value requested by a control, distinct from a measured condition.

/ ambient temperature: The temperature of the surrounding air at an identified place and time. / thermal zone: An area treated as a unit for heating or cooling control or assessment.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the manager. The display says target 22 degrees Celsius, and staff feel warm after 14:00.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The manager asks whether lowering the setting will solve the complaint. Keep the exchange to information gathering, not operating advice.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Is 22 degrees the target shown on the thermostat, or a measured room-temperature reading? I will record it as the setpoint if that is the display label. The staff's report concerns feeling warm in the meeting-room zone after 14:00. We still need to distinguish that comfort report from measured conditions and any technical finding.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Retrieve occupational vocabulary

1. Select four terms from the reference. Explain each in plain English, give two natural collocations and quote or create a short workplace example. Label invented examples. Contrast each term with a plausible confusable term; acknowledge regional variation.
2. Present one role-labelled exchange with one missing word or phrase and four choices A-D. Exactly one choice must fit the stated facts and grammar. Stop and wait for my answer before revealing it.
3. Explain all four options, then invite me to read the completed exchange aloud. Offer a sentence frame for optional spoken practice, never an open-ended writing assignment.
4. Repeat for the other three terms, one question at a time. Vary the correct letter and the situation; preserve the reference facts. If a choice is ambiguous, replace the item.
5. Finish with two new four-choice collocation questions for later review, with a clearly separate answer key. Do not claim to schedule a reminder.

END PROMPT

Test recall and transfer

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Review with supported choices and speaking

1. Ask me to close my notes. Prepare six four-choice questions: two vocabulary gaps, one grammar contrast, one confirmed-versus-unknown distinction, one choice of reply, and one transfer to a clearly labelled fictional variation.
2. Show only the first question. Use a short role-labelled exchange or a concrete scenario, four plausible choices A-D, and exactly one defensible answer. Stop and wait.
3. After each answer explain all options, offer one hint for a retry if needed, and invite me to say the completed exchange aloud. Only then move on. Do not request an original written response.
4. Track whether I answered independently or with a hint, not a certified proficiency score. Do not assess pronunciation from typed text. Replace ambiguous questions and accept valid spoken alternatives.
5. Give a compact review card with three four-choice recall items and a separate answer section. Summarize two specific successes and two points to revisit. Do not claim to remember or schedule future sessions.

END PROMPT